COACH YOUR WAY OUT

The Story Check

How your mind filters experience

Use this after the lesson, any time a situation leaves you doubting yourself. Choose something everyday or a manageable business moment. Type straight into the boxes, or print it and write by hand.

1 What happened

Only what you could have seen or recorded. For example: "I sent a message on Tuesday and have had no reply."

2 The story I am telling myself

What am I deciding this means? For example: "I have made a fool of myself."

3 The evidence

What evidence do I actually have for this story, and what evidence do I have against it?

EVIDENCE FOR

EVIDENCE AGAINST

TWO QUESTIONS TO HOLD ON TO

"What's the story I'm telling myself about what this means?"
"What evidence do I actually have?"

Now check it

4 Look for the gaps

Three questions. The labels help you ask better questions; you do not need to sort every thought perfectly.

DELETION

What information might be missing?

DISTORTION

What am I assuming?

GENERALISATION

Have I turned this one experience into a wider rule?

5 What else could explain this?

No long list needed, and no need to pick the most comforting answer. Notice what is still uncertain.

6 A useful next step

Given what I actually know, what would help?

SHARE IN THE COMMUNITY

Complete one of these in the community underneath the lesson:

- The story I caught myself telling was… and the evidence I actually had was…
- The question that helped me most was… because…
- One thing I'm going to notice this week is…

Please keep other people's details private. You don't need to share the whole story, just what you learned.